



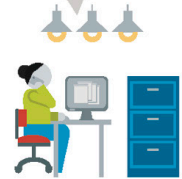
Operating Ethically

If you take an ethical approach to business by acting honestly and openly with your customers and suppliers, you will gain a reputation as a fair businessperson.

Taking responsibility

Running your business in an ethical way is important and pays dividends. Customers prefer to buy from ethical sellers, staff prefer to work for those who treat them fairly, and gaining a good reputation will help you build a loyal following.

Think about how you would like your business to operate by setting out your values. For example, you may decide that your company will be dedicated to supporting the local community or committed to protecting the environment. Or you may focus on employee health



Workplace

Identify how you can make your business a good place to work and ensure that you treat all of your employees fairly and equally.

Creating a code of conduct

Think about your business from different viewpoints to help you decide what to include in your code of conduct. The following headings are useful for most businesses, but you may want to add others, depending on the nature of your work.



Community

Think about how your business can contribute to the local community. You could sponsor a sports team or donate to a charity. Try to avoid causing any negative impacts on your neighbors such as noise or pollution.



Environment

Think about the effects your business has on the environment. Identify ways you can minimize any damage. For example, you could use only recyclable packaging or adopt a cycle-to-work program to help your employees offset the cost of a new bike.

